

(MATH000) Mathematical Language

Notation and Conventions

Jungwoo Kim

Department of Mathematics, Pohang University of Science and Technology

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Part I. General Mathematical Language

1 General Conventions

These conventions apply throughout. Widely used standard alternatives may be listed for the same concept in preferred order; the first is used throughout.

Item	Convention
Scalars	Ordinary mathematical italic letters, for example a, b, c, λ, t .
Vectors	Bold lowercase letters, for example $\mathbf{u}, \mathbf{v}, \mathbf{x}$. Unless otherwise stated, vectors are column vectors.
Matrices	Bold uppercase letters, for example $\mathbf{A}, \mathbf{B}, \mathbf{M}$. Parentheses are the preferred matrix delimiters; square brackets are a standard alternative.
Greek vectors and matrices	Bold Greek letters when a Greek symbol denotes a vector or matrix, for example $\boldsymbol{\xi}$ and $\boldsymbol{\Phi}$.
Dimension subscripts	Prefer dimension subscripts when the dimension is readily available and useful; omit them when it is clear, immaterial, or not readily available rather than inferring a dimension solely to supply a subscript.
Number systems	Blackboard bold, for example $\mathbb{N}, \mathbb{Z}, \mathbb{Q}, \mathbb{R}, \mathbb{C}$.
Sets	Ordinary uppercase letters such as A, B, X, Y , unless a field-specific convention requires otherwise.
Families and collections	Calligraphic letters when useful, for example $\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{T}, \mathcal{B}$.
Named operators	Upright Roman type, for example $\det, \ker, \operatorname{im}, \operatorname{rk}$, and tr .
Large operators	Display size in displayed mathematics and notation tables; sums and products place indices above and below, limits place subscripts below, and integral bounds retain standard right-side placement.
Greek variants	Distinct glyphs represent distinct symbols; in particular, ε and ϵ are not interchangeable.

Notation	Meaning
$(a_1, \dots, a_n)$	Ordered tuple.
$(a_n)_{n \in I}, \{a_n\}_{n \in I}$	Sequence indexed by I ; parentheses are preferred, while braces are a standard alternative when the sequence interpretation is clear.
(a, b)	Open interval.
$[a, b]$	Closed interval.
$[a, b)$	Left-closed, right-open interval.
$(a, b]$	Left-open, right-closed interval.
$\{a_1, \dots, a_n\}$	Set delimiters.
$\{x \in A \mid P(x)\}$	Set-builder notation.
$\langle u, v \rangle$	Pairing or inner product, according to context.
$ x $	Absolute value, modulus, cardinality, or order, according to context.
$\ x\ $	Norm.
s.t.	Abbreviation for “such that” when naturally required.
$a = b$	Equality.
$a := b$	a is defined to be b .
$a \equiv b$	Identity, equivalence, or congruence, according to context.
$a \cong b$	Isomorphism or congruence, according to context.
$a \approx b$	Approximation.
$f: X \rightarrow Y$	Function or map from X to Y .
$x \mapsto f(x)$	Elementwise rule of a map.

Notation	Meaning
$g \circ f$	Composition: first f , then g .
$f _A, f \upharpoonright_A$	Restriction of f to A .
id_X	Identity map on X .

2 Theorem-like Environments

Item	Convention
Definition	Precise meaning of a term, object, property, or construction.
Notation	Introduction or declaration of notation.
Theorem	Principal mathematical result.
Proposition	Useful result of more limited scope.
Lemma	Supporting result, usually for a later proof.
Corollary	Result following readily from a preceding result.
Conjecture	Statement proposed to be true but not proved in full generality.
Hypothesis	Named assumption or proposed statement.
Formula	Distinguished computational identity or closed form.
Algorithm	Explicit step-by-step procedure.
Fact	Verified statement not requiring theorem status.
Example	Illustration of a definition, construction, phenomenon, or result.
Counterexample	Example disproving a general assertion or showing a hypothesis is necessary.
Remark	Supplementary context, warning, or qualification.
Problem	Mathematical task intended to be solved.
Open Problem	Problem not known to be solved in the stated form.
Idea	Decisive conceptual insight.
Strategy	Broad problem-solving plan.
Tactic	Local step within a larger strategy.

Proof labels are written as *Proof* and solution labels as *Solution*, each followed by a period.

Notation	Meaning
□	Ending for ordinary proofs and solutions.
■	Ending for substantial, difficult, or particularly important proofs.
Q.E.D.	Ending for exceptionally difficult, significant, or paper-level proofs.

Enumeration and Subdivision. Enumeration labels are set in upright Roman type. Their form is determined by structural role rather than nesting depth.

Item	Convention
1.1, 1.2, 1.3, ...	Independent child problems or standalone units under a common parent; each may be referenced separately.
(1), (2), (3), ...	Ordinary enumerated items, such as choices, cases, examples, or procedural steps.
(a), (b), (c), ...	Connected subparts of a single problem sharing a common setup.
(i), (ii), (iii), ...	Formal mathematical clauses, such as hypotheses, conditions, properties, or equivalent statements within definitions, theorems, propositions, and related statements.

The distinction between 1.1 and (a) is independence: 1.1 denotes a standalone child unit, whereas (a) denotes a connected subpart of one problem. Likewise, (1) is used for ordinary enumeration, while (i) is reserved for formal mathematical clauses. Nested enumeration preserves these roles; for example, a subpart (a) may contain formal clauses (i), (ii), ...

Mathematical Shorthand. Typeset abbreviations may be used in typeset mathematical writing as well as handwritten work. Handwritten shorthand is reserved for notes, scratch work, and blackboard writing.

Typeset Abbreviations.

Notation	Meaning
i.e.	“that is.”
i.o.w.	“in other words.”
s.t.	“such that”; preferred when an abbreviation is natural in typeset mathematical writing.
iff	“if and only if.”
w.r.t.	“with respect to.”
const	“constant.”
N.t.	“note that.”
w.l.o.g.	“without loss of generality.”
w.t.s.	“want to show (that).”
e.t.s.	“enough to show (that).”
t.f.a.e.	“the following are equivalent.”
i.t.s.w.	“in the same way.”
o.t.o.h.	“on the other hand.”
IVT	Intermediate Value Theorem.
EVT	Extreme Value Theorem.
MVT	Mean Value Theorem.
FTC	Fundamental Theorem of Calculus.
ODE	Ordinary Differential Equation.
PDE	Partial Differential Equation.
IVP	Initial Value Problem.
BVP	Boundary Value Problem.

Handwritten Shorthand.

Notation	Meaning
Def	“definition.”
Thm	“theorem.”
Prop	“proposition.”
Lem	“lemma.”
Cor	“corollary.”
Pf	“proof.”
Sol	“solution.”
Ex	“example.”
Exer	“exercise.”
Rmk	“remark.”
Sps	“suppose (that).”
cont	“continuous.”
cont.ly	“continuously.”
difb	“differentiable.”
difb.ly	“differentiably.”
difl	“differential.”
bdd	“bounded.”
unif	“uniform.”
unif.ly	“uniformly.”
lin	“linear.”
lin.ly	“linearly.”
dep	“dependent.”
indep	“independent.”
approx	“approximate.”
triv	“trivial.”
fnc	“function.”
seq	“sequence.”
eqn	“equation.”
eqlt	“equality.”
ineqlt	“inequality.”
sys	“system.”
comb	“combination.”
vec	“vector.”
mat	“matrix.”
col	“column.”
pt	“point.”
bdy	“boundary.”
nbhd	“neighborhood.”
itvl	“interval.”
op	“operation.”
num	“number.”
val	“value.”
elmt	“element.”
cw	“clockwise.”
ccw	“counterclockwise.”
w/	“with.”

Notation	Meaning
w/o	“without.”

Mathematical Phrases.

Phrase	Use
We find by inspection that ...	Used when a conclusion follows directly from inspection.

Part II. Notation by Mathematical Area**3 Set Theory and Logic**

Uppercase letters usually denote sets; lowercase letters usually denote their elements.

Notation	Meaning
$\mathbb{N} = \{1, 2, 3, \dots\}$	Positive integers.
$\mathbb{N}_0 = \{0, 1, 2, 3, \dots\}$	Nonnegative integers.
$\mathbb{Z}$	Integers.
$\mathbb{Q}$	Rational numbers.
$\mathbb{R}$	Real numbers.
$\mathbb{C}$	Complex numbers.
$\emptyset, \emptyset$	Empty set.
$x \in A$	x is an element of A .
$x \notin A$	x is not an element of A .
$A \subseteq B$	A is a subset of B ; equality is allowed.
$A \subsetneq B$	A is a proper subset of B .
$A \supseteq B$	A is a superset of B ; equality is allowed.
$A \supsetneq B$	A is a proper superset of B .
$A \cup B$	Union.
$A \cap B$	Intersection.
$\bigcup_{i \in I} A_i$	Union of an indexed family of sets.
$\bigcap_{i \in I} A_i$	Intersection of an indexed family of sets.
$A \setminus B, A - B$	Set difference.
$A \triangle B, A \Delta B$	Symmetric difference.
A^c	Complement of A in the ambient set.
$\mathcal{P}(A), 2^A$	Power set of A .
$A \times B$	Cartesian product.
$A \sqcup B, A \dot{\cup} B$	Disjoint union.
$A \cap B = \emptyset$	A and B are disjoint.
$ A , \#A$	Cardinality.
$\{x \in A \mid P(x)\}$	Elements $x \in A$ satisfying $P(x)$.
$R \subseteq X \times Y$	Binary relation between X and Y .
xRy	x is related to y by the relation R .
R^{-1}	Inverse relation of R .
$[x]_R, [x], R[x]$	Equivalence class of x under R ; abbreviated forms are used when the relation is clear.
$x \sim y$	Equivalent elements under an understood equivalence relation.

Notation	Meaning
$A/\sim$	Set of equivalence classes.
$\forall x \in A$	For every $x \in A$.
$\exists x \in A$	There exists $x \in A$.
$\exists!x \in A$	There exists a unique $x \in A$.
$\nexists x \in A$	There does not exist $x \in A$.
$P \Rightarrow Q$	P implies Q .
$P \Leftarrow Q$	Q implies P .
$P \nRightarrow Q$	P does not imply Q .
$P \Leftrightarrow Q$	P if and only if Q .
$P \wedge Q$	Logical conjunction.
$P \vee Q$	Logical disjunction.
$\neg P$	Logical negation.
$\bot$	Contradiction reached in a proof or argument.
$\therefore$	Therefore; indicates a conclusion from preceding statements.
$\because$	Because; indicates a reason or justification.
$\text{dom } f$	Domain of f .
$\text{codom } f$	Codomain of f .
$f(A)$	Image of A under f .
$f^{-1}(B)$	Preimage of B under f .
$\text{im } f$	Image of the map f .
$f: X \hookrightarrow Y$	Injective map.
$f: X \twoheadrightarrow Y$	Surjective map.
$f: X \xleftrightarrow{\sim} Y$	Bijjective map.
$f: X \xrightarrow{\sim} Y$	Isomorphism; for sets, equivalently a bijection.
$\mathbb{1}_A(x)$	Indicator function of A .
$\aleph_0$	Cardinality of a countably infinite set.
$\mathfrak{c}$	Cardinality of the continuum.

4 Calculus and Analysis

The differential d is upright; ε is the default small positive quantity in analysis. Function spaces take their domains in parentheses, for example $C([a, b])$, $\mathcal{R}([a, b])$, and $L^p(\Omega)$.

Notation	Meaning
$\lim_{x \rightarrow a} f(x)$	Limit as x approaches a .
$\lim_{x \rightarrow a^-} f(x)$	Left-hand limit as x approaches a .
$\lim_{x \rightarrow a^+} f(x)$	Right-hand limit as x approaches a .
$\min A$	Minimum of A .
$\max A$	Maximum of A .
$\inf A$	Infimum of A .
$\sup A$	Supremum of A .
$f'(a)$	First derivative of f at a .
$f^{(n)}(a)$	n th derivative of f at a .
$\frac{dy}{dx}$	Derivative of y with respect to x .
$\frac{\partial f}{\partial x_i}$, $\partial_i f$	Partial derivative with respect to x_i .

Notation	Meaning
$\int_a^b f(x) \, dx$	Definite integral over $[a, b]$.
$\iint_D f \, dA$	Double integral over D .
$\iiint_\Omega f \, dV$	Triple integral over Ω .
$\int_C f(z) \, dz$	Contour integral along an oriented contour C .
$\oint_C f(z) \, dz$	Contour integral over a closed contour C .
$-C$	The contour C with the opposite orientation.
γ^{-1}	Reversed parametrized path γ , when unambiguous; not a functional inverse.
PV, P.V.	Principal value; in particular, the Cauchy principal value of a singular or improper integral.
$\sum_{k=1}^n a_k$	Finite sum.
$\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} a_k$	Infinite series.
$\prod_{k=1}^n a_k$	Finite product.
$e^x, \exp x$	Exponential function.
$\ln x, \log_e x$	Logarithm to base e .
$\lg x, \log_{10} x$	Logarithm to base 10.
$\text{lb } x, \log_2 x$	Logarithm to base 2.
$\log_a x$	Logarithm to base a .
$\sin x$	Sine.
$\cos x$	Cosine.
$\tan x$	Tangent.
$\csc x$	Cosecant.
$\sec x$	Secant.
$\cot x$	Cotangent.
$\arcsin x, \sin^{-1} x$	Principal inverse sine.
$\arccos x, \cos^{-1} x$	Principal inverse cosine.
$\arctan x, \tan^{-1} x$	Principal inverse tangent.
$\text{arccsc } x, \csc^{-1} x$	Principal inverse cosecant.
$\text{arcsec } x, \sec^{-1} x$	Principal inverse secant.
$\text{arccot } x, \cot^{-1} x$	Principal inverse cotangent.
$\sinh x$	Hyperbolic sine.
$\cosh x$	Hyperbolic cosine.
$\tanh x$	Hyperbolic tangent.
$\text{csch } x$	Hyperbolic cosecant.
$\text{sech } x$	Hyperbolic secant.
$\coth x$	Hyperbolic cotangent.

Notation	Meaning
$\operatorname{arcsinh} x, \sinh^{-1} x$	Principal inverse hyperbolic sine.
$\operatorname{arccosh} x, \cosh^{-1} x$	Principal inverse hyperbolic cosine.
$\operatorname{arctanh} x, \tanh^{-1} x$	Principal inverse hyperbolic tangent.
$\operatorname{arccsch} x, \operatorname{csch}^{-1} x$	Principal inverse hyperbolic cosecant.
$\operatorname{arcsech} x, \operatorname{sech}^{-1} x$	Principal inverse hyperbolic secant.
$\operatorname{arccoth} x, \operatorname{coth}^{-1} x$	Principal inverse hyperbolic cotangent.
$\Gamma(z)$	Gamma function.
$B(x, y)$	Beta function.
$\zeta(s)$	Riemann zeta function.
$D\mathbf{F}(\mathbf{a})$	Total derivative; Jacobian matrix in coordinates.
$\operatorname{Jac}(\mathbf{F})$	Jacobian determinant.
$\operatorname{Hess} f$	Hessian matrix of f .
∇f	Gradient of f .
$\nabla \cdot \mathbf{F}$	Divergence of $\mathbf{F}$.
$\nabla \times \mathbf{F}$	Curl of $\mathbf{F}$.
Δf	Laplacian of f .
$\mathbf{r}(t)$	Parametrized curve.
ds	Element of arc length.
$\int_C \mathbf{F} \cdot d\mathbf{r}$	Line integral along C .
$\iint_S \mathbf{F} \cdot \mathbf{n} \, dS$	Flux integral through S .
$x_n \rightarrow x$	Convergence of a sequence.
$a_n \nearrow L$	Monotone increasing convergence to L .
$a_n \searrow L$	Monotone decreasing convergence to L .
$\limsup a_n$	Limit superior.
$\liminf a_n$	Limit inferior.
$f_n \rightarrow f, f_n \xrightarrow{\text{ptw}} f$	Pointwise convergence.
$f_n \rightrightarrows f, f_n \xrightarrow{\text{unif}} f$	Uniform convergence.
$f_n \xrightarrow{\text{a.e.}} f$	Convergence almost everywhere.
$C(\Omega), C^0(\Omega)$	Continuous functions on Ω .
$C^k(\Omega)$	k times continuously differentiable functions on Ω .
$C^\infty(\Omega)$	Smooth functions on Ω .
$\mathcal{R}([a, b])$	Riemann-integrable functions on $[a, b]$.
$L^p(\Omega)$	Lebesgue L^p space on Ω .
$L^\infty(\Omega)$	Lebesgue space of essentially bounded functions on Ω .
$\ f\ _\infty$	Supremum norm $\sup_{x \in \Omega} f(x) $, when finite.
$\ f\ _{L^p(\Omega)}, \ f\ _p$	L^p -norm $\left(\int_\Omega f(x) ^p \, dx \right)^{1/p}$ for $1 \leq p < \infty$.
$\ f\ _{L^\infty(\Omega)}$	L^∞ -norm $\operatorname{ess\,sup}_{x \in \Omega} f(x) $.
$B_r(x)$	Open ball of radius r centered at x .
$\overline{B}_r(x)$	Closed ball of radius r centered at x .
$\widehat{\mathbb{C}} = \mathbb{C} \cup \{\infty\}$	Extended complex plane, equivalently the Riemann sphere.
$z = x + iy$	Complex number with real part x and imaginary part y .
$\operatorname{Re} z, \Re z$	Real part of z .
$\operatorname{Im} z, \Im z$	Imaginary part of z ; distinct from lowercase im for image.

Notation	Meaning
$\bar{z}$	Complex conjugate.
$ z $	Complex modulus.
$\arg z$	Argument of a nonzero complex number z ; its values differ by integer multiples of 2π .
$\text{Arg } z$	Principal argument of $z \neq 0$, with $-\pi < \text{Arg } z \leq \pi$.
$\log z$	Complex logarithm of $z \neq 0$; a branch is specified when a single-valued logarithm is required.
$\text{Log } z = \ln z + i \text{Arg } z$	Principal complex logarithm for $z \neq 0$.
$\text{Res}(f; a), \text{Res}_{z=a} f(z)$	Residue of f at a finite point a .
$\text{Res}(f; \infty), \text{Res}_{z=\infty} f(z)$	Residue of f at infinity.

5 Linear Algebra

Notation	Meaning
$\mathbf{A} = (a_{ij}), \mathbf{A} = [a_{ij}]$	Matrix with (i, j) -entry a_{ij} ; parentheses are preferred.
$\mathbf{A}^\top$	Transpose of $\mathbf{A}$.
$\mathbf{A}^H$	Conjugate transpose of $\mathbf{A}$.
$\mathbf{A}^{-1}$	Inverse of $\mathbf{A}$.
$\mathbf{I}_n, \mathbf{I}$	Identity matrix; the dimension subscript is preferred when readily available and useful.
$\mathbf{0}$	Zero vector or zero matrix, with dimension understood.
$\mathbf{D}$	Diagonal matrix when a local name is required.
$\mathbf{P}$	Projection matrix when a local name is required.
$\text{diag}(d_1, \dots, d_n)$	Diagonal matrix with entries $d_1, \dots, d_n$.
$\mathbf{1}$	All-ones vector.
$e^{\mathbf{A}}, \exp(\mathbf{A})$	Matrix exponential; $e^{t\mathbf{A}}$ is the standard time-dependent form.
$\det(\mathbf{A}), \mathbf{A} $	Determinant.
$\text{rk}(\mathbf{A}), \text{rank}(\mathbf{A})$	Rank.
$\text{tr}(\mathbf{A})$	Trace.
$\text{adj}(\mathbf{A})$	Adjugate matrix.
$\text{Col}(\mathbf{A})$	Column space.
$\text{Row}(\mathbf{A})$	Row space.
$\text{Null}(\mathbf{A}), \ker \mathbf{A}$	Null space.
$\ker T$	Kernel of a linear map T .
$\text{im } T$	Image of a linear map T .
$\mathbf{e}_i$	i th standard basis vector.
$\dim V$	Dimension of V .
$\text{span}(\mathbf{v}_1, \dots, \mathbf{v}_k)$	Span of the listed vectors.
$U \oplus V$	Direct sum.
$\langle \mathbf{u}, \mathbf{v} \rangle, (\mathbf{u}, \mathbf{v})$	Inner product; over complex spaces, conjugate-linear in the first argument and linear in the second.
$\mathbf{u} \cdot \mathbf{v}, \mathbf{u}^\top \mathbf{v}$	Standard Euclidean inner product on $\mathbb{R}^n$.
$\mathbf{u}^H \mathbf{v}$	Standard Hermitian inner product on $\mathbb{C}^n$.
$\ \mathbf{v}\ $	Norm of $\mathbf{v}$.
$\mathbf{u} \perp \mathbf{v}$	Orthogonality.
$U^\perp$	Orthogonal complement of the subspace U .
$\text{proj}_U \mathbf{x}$	Orthogonal projection of $\mathbf{x}$ onto the subspace U .

Notation	Meaning
$\text{proj}_{\mathbf{v}} \mathbf{x}$	Orthogonal projection of $\mathbf{x}$ onto $\text{span}(\mathbf{v})$.
$\mathbf{u} \times \mathbf{v}$	Cross product in $\mathbb{R}^3$.
$p_{\mathbf{A}}(\lambda), \chi_{\mathbf{A}}(\lambda)$	Characteristic polynomial of $\mathbf{A}$.
$m_{\mathbf{A}}(\lambda), \mu_{\mathbf{A}}(\lambda)$	Minimal polynomial of $\mathbf{A}$.
λ, λ_i	Eigenvalue of $\mathbf{A}$.
$\mathbf{v}, \mathbf{v}_i$	Eigenvector of $\mathbf{A}$.
$E_{\lambda}(\mathbf{A}), V_{\lambda}(\mathbf{A})$	Eigenspace of $\mathbf{A}$ associated with λ .
$\sigma(\mathbf{A}), \text{spec}(\mathbf{A})$	Spectrum of $\mathbf{A}$.
$\rho(\mathbf{A})$	Spectral radius.
$\sigma_i(\mathbf{A})$	i th singular value of $\mathbf{A}$.

6 Differential Equations

Notation	Meaning
y'	First derivative with respect to the understood independent variable.
y''	Second derivative.
$\dot{x}$	First derivative of x with respect to time.
$\ddot{x}$	Second derivative of x with respect to time.
$F(t, y, y', \dots, y^{(n)}) = 0$	General n th-order ordinary differential equation.
$y^{(n)} = f(t, y, y', \dots, y^{(n-1)})$	n th-order ordinary differential equation in normal form.
$y(t_0) = y_0$	Initial condition for a scalar differential equation.
$y' + p(t)y = g(t)$	Standard form of a first-order linear differential equation.
$\mu(t)$	Integrating factor; for $y' + p(t)y = g(t)$, one may take $\mu(t) = \exp\left(\int p(t) dt\right)$ up to a nonzero constant factor.
$M(x, y) dx + N(x, y) dy = 0$	Differential form of a first-order differential equation.
M_x, M_y, N_x, N_y	Subscript notation for the corresponding partial derivatives.
$L[y]$	Linear differential operator applied to y ; $\mathcal{L}$ is reserved here for the Laplace transform.
$L[y] = \sum_{k=0}^n a_k(t)y^{(k)}$	General n th-order linear differential operator, with $a_n \neq 0$.
$L[y] = 0, L[y] = g$	Homogeneous and nonhomogeneous linear differential equations, respectively.
y_h, y_c	Homogeneous or complementary part of a solution; y_h is preferred.
y_p	Particular solution.
$c_1, c_2, \dots$	Arbitrary constants in a general solution.
$\sum_{k=0}^n a_k r^k = 0$	Characteristic equation for a constant-coefficient homogeneous linear differential equation.
$r_1, \dots, r_n$	Characteristic roots; multiplicities are counted when relevant.
$W(y_1, \dots, y_n)(t),$ $W[y_1, \dots, y_n](t)$	Wronskian of $y_1, \dots, y_n$; parentheses are preferred.
$y(x) = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n(x - x_0)^n$	Power-series form about the ordinary point x_0 .

Notation	Meaning
$y(x) = (x - x_0)^r \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n (x - x_0)^n$	Frobenius-series form about a regular singular point x_0 ; r denotes an indicial exponent.
$\mathbf{x}' = \mathbf{f}(t, \mathbf{x})$	General first-order system.
$\mathbf{x}(t_0) = \mathbf{x}_0$	Initial condition for a first-order system.
$\mathbf{x}' = \mathbf{A}\mathbf{x} + \mathbf{g}(t)$	Linear first-order system in state-vector form.
$\dot{\mathbf{x}} = \mathbf{A}\mathbf{x} + \mathbf{g}(t)$	
$\mathbf{x}' = \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x})$	Autonomous first-order system.
$\mathbf{x}_*$	Equilibrium point; $\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}_*) = \mathbf{0}$.
$\Phi(t)$	Fundamental matrix of a linear system.
$\mathcal{L}\{f(t)\}(s)$, $\mathcal{L}[f](s)$	Laplace transform of f .
$\mathcal{L}^{-1}\{F(s)\}(t)$, $\mathcal{L}^{-1}[F](t)$	Inverse Laplace transform of F .
$(f * g)(t)$	One-sided convolution, $(f * g)(t) := \int_0^t f(\tau)g(t - \tau) \, d\tau$.
$H(t - a)$, $u(t - a)$	Heaviside or unit-step function shifted to $t = a$; H is preferred, and its value at the jump is specified when relevant.
$\delta(t)$, $\delta(t - a)$	Dirac delta distribution, or unit impulse, centered at 0 or shifted to $t = a$.
$t_n = t_0 + nh$	Uniform numerical grid with step size $h > 0$.
$y_n \approx y(t_n)$	Numerical approximation to the exact solution at t_n .
$u_x, u_t, u_{xx}, u_{xy}, u_{tt}, \dots$	Subscript notation for partial derivatives of a scalar function u .
$\partial_{\mathbf{n}}u$	Normal derivative, $\partial_{\mathbf{n}}u := \nabla u \cdot \mathbf{n}$, for a unit normal vector $\mathbf{n}$.
$u _{\partial\Omega} = g$	Dirichlet boundary condition on $\partial\Omega$.
$\partial_{\mathbf{n}}u _{\partial\Omega} = g$	Neumann boundary condition on $\partial\Omega$.
$\alpha u + \beta \partial_{\mathbf{n}}u = g$	Robin boundary condition on $\partial\Omega$.
a_n , b_n	Fourier coefficients for the real $2L$ -periodic convention
	$f(x) \sim \frac{a_0}{2} + \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \left(a_n \cos \frac{n\pi x}{L} + b_n \sin \frac{n\pi x}{L} \right)$.
a_n	$a_n = \frac{1}{L} \int_{-L}^L f(x) \cos \frac{n\pi x}{L} \, dx$ for $n \geq 0$.
b_n	$b_n = \frac{1}{L} \int_{-L}^L f(x) \sin \frac{n\pi x}{L} \, dx$ for $n \geq 1$.
$\hat{f}(\boldsymbol{\xi})$, $\mathcal{F}f(\boldsymbol{\xi})$	Fourier transform under the normalization $\hat{f}(\boldsymbol{\xi}) := \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} f(\mathbf{x}) e^{-2\pi i \mathbf{x} \cdot \boldsymbol{\xi}} \, d\mathbf{x}$; inversion uses $f(\mathbf{x}) = \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} \hat{f}(\boldsymbol{\xi}) e^{2\pi i \mathbf{x} \cdot \boldsymbol{\xi}} \, d\boldsymbol{\xi}$ whenever applicable.
$-(p(x)y')' + q(x)y = \lambda w(x)y$	Sturm–Liouville eigenvalue equation with weight function w .
λ_n , ϕ_n	Eigenvalue and corresponding eigenfunction of a Sturm–Liouville problem.
$\langle f, g \rangle_w$	Weighted inner product, $\langle f, g \rangle_w := \int_a^b \overline{f(x)} g(x) w(x) \, dx$.
δ_{mn}	Kronecker delta: 1 if $m = n$ and 0 otherwise.
$\langle \phi_m, \phi_n \rangle_w = \delta_{mn}$	Weighted orthonormality of eigenfunctions.
$G(x, \xi)$, $G(\mathbf{x}, \boldsymbol{\xi})$	Green's function, with scalar or vector variables according to context.

Notation	Meaning
$\text{Ai}(x)$, $\text{Bi}(x)$	Airy functions.
$J_\nu(x)$	Bessel function of the first kind of order ν .
$Y_\nu(x)$, $N_\nu(x)$	Bessel function of the second kind (Neumann function) of order ν ; Y_ν is preferred.
$I_\nu(x)$, $K_\nu(x)$	Modified Bessel functions of the first and second kinds.
$H_\nu^{(1)}(x)$, $H_\nu^{(2)}(x)$	Hankel functions of the first and second kinds.
$P_n(x)$	Legendre polynomial of degree n .
$P_\nu(x)$, $Q_\nu(x)$	Legendre functions of the first and second kinds.
$P_\ell^m(x)$	Associated Legendre function for integer degree ℓ and order m .
$H_n(x)$, $\text{He}_n(x)$	Physicists' and probabilists' Hermite polynomials, respectively.
$L_n^{(\alpha)}(x)$, $L_n(x)$	Generalized Laguerre polynomial and ordinary Laguerre polynomial, with $L_n(x) = L_n^{(0)}(x)$.
$T_n(x)$, $U_n(x)$	Chebyshev polynomials of the first and second kinds.
$P_n^{(\alpha, \beta)}(x)$	Jacobi polynomial.
$C_n^{(\lambda)}(x)$	Gegenbauer (ultraspherical) polynomial.
$\text{erf}(x)$, $\text{erfc}(x)$	Error function and complementary error function.
${}_2F_1(a, b; c; z)$	Gauss hypergeometric function.

7 Combinatorics and Discrete Mathematics

Notation	Meaning
$\binom{n}{r}$, ${}_nC_r$	Number of r -element subsets of an n -element set.
$\left(\binom{n}{r}\right)$, ${}_nH_r$	r -combinations with repetition from n types; equals $\binom{n+r-1}{r}$.
$n!$	Factorial.
$n^{\underline{k}}$, $(n)_k$	Falling factorial.
$n^{\overline{k}}$, $n^{(k)}$	Rising factorial.
$O(g(n))$	Big-O upper asymptotic bound.
$o(g(n))$	Little-o strict asymptotic bound.
$\Theta(g(n))$	Two-sided asymptotic order.
$\Omega(g(n))$	Asymptotic lower bound.
$(X, \preceq)$	Partially ordered set (poset).
$\prec, \succeq, \succ$	Strict and reverse order relations associated with $\preceq$.
$\leq_{\text{lex}}$	Lexicographic order.
$x \leq y$	Cover relation: y covers x .
B_n	Boolean lattice (Boolean poset) on an n -element ground set.
$G = (V, E)$	Graph with vertex set V and edge set E .
$V(G)$	Vertex set of G .
$E(G)$	Edge set of G .
$N(v)$, $\Gamma(v)$	Neighborhood of vertex v .
$\deg_G(v)$, $\deg(v)$	Degree of vertex v ; the graph subscript may be omitted when clear.
$\deg^+(v)$, $\deg^-(v)$	Out-degree and in-degree of v in a directed graph.
$d_G(u, v)$, $d(u, v)$	Graph distance between vertices u and v .
K_n	Complete graph on n vertices.
$K_{m,n}$	Complete bipartite graph with parts of sizes m and n .
P_n	Path graph on n vertices.

Notation	Meaning
C_n	Cycle graph on n vertices.
$\mathbf{A}(G)$, $\mathbf{A}_G$	Adjacency matrix of G .
$\mathbf{L}(G)$, $\mathbf{L}_G$	Graph Laplacian, usually $\mathbf{D}(G) - \mathbf{A}(G)$.
$G - e$	Graph obtained by deleting the edge e .
G/e , $G : e$	Graph obtained by contracting the edge e ; G/e is the preferred notation.
$T(G)$, $\tau(G)$	Number of spanning trees of G ; $T(G)$ is preferred here to avoid conflict with the standard number-theoretic $\tau(n)$.
$r(k, \ell)$, $r(k)$	Ramsey numbers; $r(k) = r(k, k)$.
$A(x) = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n x^n$	Ordinary generating function of the sequence $(a_n)_{n \geq 0}$.

8 Probability and Statistics

Probability and expectation are written in blackboard bold by default. For gamma distributions, β denotes a rate parameter and θ a scale parameter, so $\theta = 1/\beta$. The geometric distribution counts the number of trials up to and including the first success.

Notation	Meaning
$\mathbb{P}(A)$, $P(A)$	Probability of event A .
$\mathbb{P}(A \mid B)$, $P(A \mid B)$	Conditional probability of A given B .
$X \perp\!\!\!\perp Y$	X and Y are independent.
$X \perp\!\!\!\perp Y \mid Z$	X and Y are conditionally independent given Z .
$p_X(x) = \mathbb{P}(X = x)$	Probability mass function (pmf) of a discrete random variable X .
$f_X(x)$	Probability density function (pdf) of a continuous random variable X .
$F_X(x) = \mathbb{P}(X \leq x)$	Cumulative distribution function (cdf) of X .
$p_{X,Y}(x, y)$, $f_{X,Y}(x, y)$	Joint pmf or joint pdf of (X, Y) , according to context.
$p_{X Y}(x \mid y)$, $f_{X Y}(x \mid y)$	Conditional pmf or conditional pdf of X given $Y = y$, according to context.
$F^{-1}(p) = \inf\{x \in \mathbb{R} \mid F(x) \geq p\}$	Generalized inverse of a cdf F ; the p -quantile, for $0 < p < 1$.
$\mathbb{E}[X]$, $E[X]$	Expectation of random variable X .
$\mathbb{E}[X \mid Y]$, $E[X \mid Y]$	Conditional expectation of X given Y .
$\text{Var}(X)$	Variance of X .
$\text{Cov}(X, Y)$	Covariance of X and Y .
$\rho_{X,Y}$	Population correlation coefficient of X and Y .
r	Sample correlation coefficient, when the sample is understood.
$\varphi_X(t) = \mathbb{E}[e^{itX}]$	Characteristic function of X .
$M_X(t) = \mathbb{E}[e^{tX}]$	Moment-generating function (mgf) of X , when finite in a neighborhood of 0.
$\bar{X} = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n X_i$	Sample mean as a statistic of a random sample $X_1, \dots, X_n$.
$\bar{x} = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n x_i$	Observed sample mean for data $x_1, \dots, x_n$.
$S^2 = \frac{1}{n-1} \sum_{i=1}^n (X_i - \bar{X})^2$	Sample variance as a statistic.

Notation	Meaning
$s^2 = \frac{1}{n-1} \sum_{i=1}^n (x_i - \bar{x})^2$	Observed sample variance.
$S = \sqrt{S^2}$, $s = \sqrt{s^2}$	Sample standard deviation as a statistic and its observed value.
$\hat{\theta}$	Estimator or estimate of a parameter θ , according to context.
$\hat{p}$	Estimator or estimate of a probability parameter p ; commonly the sample proportion.
$\text{SE}(\hat{\theta})$	Standard error of an estimator $\hat{\theta}$.
$L(\theta; \mathbf{x})$	Likelihood function for parameter θ given observed data $\mathbf{x}$.
$\ell(\theta; \mathbf{x}) = \log L(\theta; \mathbf{x})$	Log-likelihood function.
H_0	Null hypothesis.
H_1 , H_a	Alternative hypothesis; H_1 is preferred.
α	Significance level; an upper bound on the Type I error probability under the specified test.
β	Type II error probability under a specified alternative.
ν	Degrees of freedom.
$X \sim \text{Bern}(p)$	Bernoulli distribution with success probability p .
$X \sim \text{Bin}(n, p)$	Binomial distribution.
$X \sim \text{Geom}(p)$, $\mathbb{P}(X = k) = (1-p)^{k-1}p$	Geometric distribution on $\mathbb{N}$, counting trials up to and including the first success.
$X \sim \text{Pois}(\lambda)$	Poisson distribution with parameter λ .
$X \sim \text{Unif}(a, b)$	Continuous uniform distribution on $[a, b]$.
$X \sim \text{Exp}(\lambda)$	Exponential distribution with rate λ .
$X \sim \Gamma(\alpha, \beta)$	Gamma distribution with shape α and rate β .
$X \sim \Gamma(\alpha, \theta)$	Gamma distribution with shape α and scale θ ; here $\theta = 1/\beta$.
$X \sim \mathcal{N}(\mu, \sigma^2)$, $X \sim N(\mu, \sigma^2)$	Normal distribution with mean μ and variance σ^2 .
$X \sim \chi_\nu^2$	Chi-squared distribution with ν degrees of freedom.
$X \sim t_\nu$	Student's t distribution with ν degrees of freedom.
$X \sim F_{\nu_1, \nu_2}$	F distribution with numerator and denominator degrees of freedom ν_1, ν_2 .
$X_n \xrightarrow{\text{a.s.}} X$	Almost-sure convergence.
$X_n \xrightarrow{\mathbb{P}} X$	Convergence in probability.
$X_n \xrightarrow{L^p} X$	Convergence in L^p .
$X_n \xrightarrow{d} X$, $X_n \Rightarrow X$	Convergence in distribution.

9 Geometry

In triangle notation, A, B, C denote vertices and a, b, c the opposite side lengths.

Notation	Meaning
$\triangle ABC$	Triangle with vertices A, B, C .
$\angle ABC$	Angle with vertex B .
$\overline{AB}$	Segment joining A and B .
AB	Length of $\overline{AB}$.
$[ABC]$	Area of $\triangle ABC$.
$\text{length}(C)$, $\ell(C)$	Length of C .
$\text{area}(S)$	Area of S .

Notation	Meaning
$\text{vol}(S)$	Volume of S .
$\text{dist}(P, S)$	Distance from P to S .
$\text{conv}(S)$	Convex hull of S .
$\mathbb{R}^n$	n -dimensional real Euclidean space.
$\mathbb{H}^n$	n -dimensional hyperbolic space.
$\parallel$	Parallel.
$\perp$	Perpendicular or orthogonal.

10 Number Theory

Notation	Meaning
$a \mid b$	a divides b .
$a \nmid b$	a does not divide b .
$\gcd(a, b)$	Greatest common divisor, taken nonnegative.
$\text{lcm}(a, b)$	Least common multiple.
$a \equiv b \pmod{n}$	a is congruent to b modulo n .
$[a]_n$	Residue class of a modulo n .
$\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$	Ring of residue classes modulo n .
$(\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^\times$	Multiplicative group of units modulo n .
$a^{-1} \pmod{n}$	Multiplicative inverse of a modulo n .
$\left(\frac{a}{p}\right)$	Legendre symbol.
$\varphi(n)$	Euler totient function.
$\text{ord}_n(a)$	Multiplicative order of a modulo n .
$v_p(n), \nu_p(n)$	p -adic valuation of n .
$\tau(n)$	Number of positive divisors of n .
$\sigma(n)$	Sum of positive divisors of n .
$\mu(n)$	Möbius function.
$\text{rad}(n)$	Product of the distinct prime divisors of n .
$\pi(x)$	Number of primes not exceeding x .
$\mathbb{F}_q, \text{GF}(q)$	Finite field with q elements.

11 Algebra

G, H usually denote groups, R, S rings, I, J ideals, M, N modules, and F, K, L fields. Modules are left modules unless otherwise stated.

Notation	Meaning
G	Group.
$e, 1_G$	Identity element of a group.
g^{-1}	Inverse of $g \in G$.
$ G $	Order (cardinality) of G .
$\text{ord}(g), g $	Order of the element g .
$\langle S \rangle$	Subgroup generated by $S \subseteq G$.
$\langle g \rangle$	Cyclic subgroup generated by g .
$H \leq G$	H is a subgroup of G .
$H \trianglelefteq G$	H is a normal subgroup of G .

Notation	Meaning
gH, Hg	Left and right cosets of H in G .
$[G : H]$	Index of H in G .
G/H	Quotient group, for $H \trianglelefteq G$.
$\ker \varphi$	Kernel of the homomorphism φ .
$\operatorname{im} \varphi$	Image of the homomorphism φ .
$\operatorname{Aut}(G)$	Automorphism group of G .
$\operatorname{Inn}(G)$	Inner automorphism group of G .
$Z(G)$	Center of G .
$C_G(A), C_G(x)$	Centralizer in G of $A \subseteq G$ or $x \in G$.
$N_G(A), N_G(H)$	Normalizer in G of $A \subseteq G$ or $H \leq G$.
$[x, y] := x^{-1}y^{-1}xy$	Commutator of x and y .
$[G, G], G'$	Commutator (derived) subgroup of G .
$\operatorname{Syl}_p(G)$	Set of Sylow p -subgroups of G .
n_p	Number of Sylow p -subgroups of G .
$G \curvearrowright X$	Action of G on X .
$g \cdot x$	Action of $g \in G$ on $x \in X$.
$G \cdot x$	Orbit of x under the action of G .
$\operatorname{Stab}_G(x), G_x$	Stabilizer of x in G .
$G \times H$	Direct product of groups.
$N \rtimes_{\varphi} H$	Semidirect product determined by $\varphi: H \rightarrow \operatorname{Aut}(N)$, with N the normal factor.
$\langle S \mid R \rangle$	Group presentation with generators S and relations R .
C_n	Cyclic group of order n .
D_n	Dihedral group of symmetries of a regular n -gon; $ D_n = 2n$.
$S_n, \mathfrak{S}_n$	Symmetric group on n symbols.
$A_n, \mathfrak{A}_n$	Alternating group on n symbols.
V_4	Klein four-group.
Q_8	Quaternion group of order 8.
$\operatorname{GL}_n(F)$	General linear group over F .
$\operatorname{SL}_n(F)$	Special linear group over F .
R	Ring.
$0_R, 1_R$	Additive and multiplicative identities of R , when disambiguation is useful.
$R^{\times}$	Group of units of R .
I, J	Ideals of R , when the ambient ring is clear.
$\mathfrak{p}, \mathfrak{q}$	Prime ideals.
$\mathfrak{m}, \mathfrak{n}$	Maximal ideals.
(a)	Principal ideal generated by a .
$(a_1, \dots, a_n)$	Ideal generated by $a_1, \dots, a_n$.
$I + J$	Sum of the ideals I and J .
IJ	Product of the ideals I and J .
R/I	Quotient ring.
$R[x], R[x_1, \dots, x_n]$	Polynomial rings over R in one or several variables.
$\deg f$	Degree of the polynomial f .
$M_n(R)$	Ring of $n \times n$ matrices over R .
$R[G]$	Group ring of G over R .
$\operatorname{Frac}(R)$	Fraction field of the integral domain R .
$\operatorname{char} R$	Characteristic of R .

Notation	Meaning
$\mathbb{H}$	Quaternion division algebra over $\mathbb{R}$.
M, N	Left R -modules, unless otherwise stated.
${}_R M, M_R$	Left and right R -modules, when the side is emphasized.
M/N	Quotient module, for a submodule N of M .
$M \oplus N$	Direct sum of modules.
$\bigoplus_{i \in I} M_i$	Direct sum of an indexed family of modules.
R^n	Free R -module of rank n .
$\text{Hom}_R(M, N)$	Set of R -module homomorphisms from M to N .
$\text{End}_R(M)$	Endomorphism ring of the R -module M .
$\text{Aut}_R(M)$	Automorphism group of the R -module M .
$\text{Ann}_R(M)$	Annihilator of the R -module M .
$M \otimes_R N$	Tensor product over R , with the required right and left module structures understood.
K/F	Field extension of F by K .
$[K : F]$	Degree of the field extension K/F .
$F(\alpha), F(\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_n)$	Fields generated over F by the indicated elements.
$F[\alpha]$	Subring (equivalently, F -subalgebra) generated by F and α .
$m_{\alpha, F}(x)$	Minimal polynomial of α over F .
$\overline{F}$	Algebraic closure of F .
$\text{Gal}(L/K)$	Galois group of L/K .
L^H	Fixed field of $H \leq \text{Gal}(L/K)$.
$\text{Tr}_{L/K}(\alpha)$	Field trace of $\alpha \in L$ from L to K .
$N_{L/K}(\alpha)$	Field norm of $\alpha \in L$ from L to K .
$\text{trdeg}_K L$	Transcendence degree of L over K .

12 Topology

Notation	Meaning
$(X, \mathcal{T})$	Topological space X with topology $\mathcal{T}$.
$A^\circ, \text{int } A$	Interior of A .
$\overline{A}, \text{cl } A$	Closure of A .
∂A	Boundary of A .
$\pi_1(X, x_0)$	Fundamental group of X based at x_0 .
$\chi(X)$	Euler characteristic of X .
$X \cong Y$	Homeomorphic spaces.
$X \simeq Y$	Homotopy equivalent spaces.

13 Miscellaneous Notation

Notation	Meaning
$\lfloor x \rfloor$	Floor of x .
$\lceil x \rceil$	Ceiling of x .
$\{x\}$	Fractional part $x - \lfloor x \rfloor$, when unambiguous.
$\text{sgn}(x)$	Sign of a real number or permutation, according to context.

Notation	Meaning
Δq	Finite change in a quantity q .
ϵ_{ijk}	Levi–Civita symbol.